Differences between Taxonomy and Systematics

Taxonomy	Systematics
• Discipline of classifying organisms into taxa. • Governs the practices of naming, describing, identifying and specimen preservation. • Classification + Nomenclature = Taxonomy	• Broad field of biology that studies the diversification of species. • Governs the evolutionary history and phylogenetic relationship in addition to taxonomy. • Taxonomy + Phylogeny = Systematics

Pharmacology and also Modern Biotechnology, Molecular Biology and Bioinformatics. It helps to understand biodiversity, wildlife, forest management of natural resources for sustainable use of plants and eco restoration.

5.1 Taxonomy and Systematics

The word taxonomy is derived from Greek words ***"taxis"*** (arrangement) and ***"nomos"*** (rules or laws). Taxonomy is defined as as "the science dealing with the study of classification including the bases, principles, rules and procedures".

Simpson (1961) defined Systematics as, "Scientific study of the kinds and diversity of organisms and all relationships among them". Though there are two terms are used in an interchangeable way, they differ from each other.

Rank	Ending	Example
Kingdom	-	Plantae
Phylum = Division	-phyta	Magnoliophyta
Subphylum = Sub division	-phytina	Magnoliophytina
Class	-opsida	Asteropsida
Sub class	-idea	Asteridea
Order	-ales	Asterales
Suborder	-ineae	Asterineae
Family	-aceae	Asteraceae
Sub family	-oideae	Asteroideae
Tribe	-eae	Heliantheae
Genus	-	*Helianthus*
Species	-	*Helianthus annuus*

5.2 Taxonomic Hierarchy

Taxonomic hierarchy was introduced by Carolus Linnaeus. It is the arrangement of various taxonomic levels in descending order starting from kingdom up to species.

Species is the lowest of classification and shows the high level of similarities among the organisms. For example, *Helianthus annuus* and *Helianthus tuberosus*. These two species differ in their morphology. Both of them are herbs but *Helianthus tuberosus* is a perennial herb.

Genus consists of multiple species which have similar characters but differ from the species of another genus. Example: *Helianthus*, *Tridax*.

Family comprises a number of genera which share some similarities among them. Example: Asteraceae.

Order includes group of families which show less similarities among them.

Class consists of group of orders which share few similarities.

Division is the next level of classification that consists of number of classes.

Example: Magnoliophyta.

Kingdom is the highest level or rank of the classification. Example: Plantae

11th Botany_EM_Chapter 5.indd 101 06/01/2023 19:43:33